← 08 · Practice spend | Step 10 of 15 — Metal and the map | 11 · Hide the wallet map →

Metal and the map

Time	Difficulty	Steps	You will need
1–2 hours	Moderate	4 sections	Titanium plates, Metal stamp set, The paper keys

S1

S2

S3

THREE PLATES THREE PLACES

A small payment has gone out and come back. Now the keys leave paper for good.

Three titanium plates. One seed per plate. Three separate places. If two plates sleep in the same house, the separation is gone — and the single point of failure is back.

The plates

- One seed per plate. Never two.
- StampSeed (recommended): the kit holds 1 plate, buy 2 more. Cryptotag: the kit holds 2, buy 1 more. Pick one method; don't mix them.
- Three places, far enough apart that one fire, flood, or burglary can't take all three.
- No photo, no note, no password manager, no email. Any copy outside the plates is a leak.

How to stamp

1. 01 · Private room, no camera. Plate on a solid block, each letter stamped deep.
2. 02 · Words numbered 1–24. Label the plate quietly — S1. No names, no "Bitcoin."
3. 03 · Read the plate back against the paper. A mis-stamp is a bricked backup.
4. 04 · Restore from the plate on offline Tails. First addresses must match.
5. 05 · Only then destroy the paper — and the bit notes with it.

The home plate

These 24 words, alone, open a small wallet. Leave a little bitcoin there: a thief who loads only those words may stop at what they find.

The same words plus a written passphrase open a modest spending wallet. The passphrase lives on paper — never on the plate, never in the same drawer. No passphrase on the 2-of-3 itself.

Where each plate lives

- **Plate A** — Seed 1 — home safe. Never Seed 2 or 3 here.
- **Plate B** — Seed 2 — off-site #1. Not the same address as A or C.
- **Plate C** — Seed 3 — off-site #2. Not the same address as A or B.

Print the output descriptor and keep it with Plate A, plus one copy off-site — never beside all three seeds. Hardware wallets don't replace these plates. Once a year: restore from the plates, receive dust, spend dust, update locations. Write a letter pointing to the packet and which two locations matter — not the words.

scan for the full sheet

Next. Hide the wallet map. The plates are not the map, and the map is not a seed.